

People

Unit 1 of 12 · Grammar Study Sheet

Introduce yourself, talk about families, and use the verb "be" (am/is/are).

What you will be able to do

- ✓ Use the verb be in sentences
- ✓ Talk about personal information
- ✓ Talk about families
- ✓ Use possessive 's and possessive adjectives
- ✓ Use everyday verbs
- ✓ Introduce myself and other people

4 lessons in this unit

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Topics: personal information · be (am/is/are) · be negative · be questions · contracted forms

Vocabulary — Personal information

first name	surname	job	occupation
place of birth	married	single	relationship
photographer	journalist	explorer	filmmaker
teacher	student	businessman	

Beverley & Dereck Joubert are National Geographic explorers and filmmakers in Botswana.

Pronunciation — Contracted forms of "be"

In spoken English we usually contract the verb "be". Learn the contractions and listen for them.

- 'm = am (I'm a photographer)
- 're = are (You/We/They're married)
- 's = is (He/She/It's from South Africa)
- 'm not = am not (I'm not a journalist)
- aren't = are not (We aren't here today)
- isn't = is not (He isn't from South America)

be (am/is/are)

Use "be" to talk about names, jobs, nationality, age, marital status, etc. Form changes with the subject.

I	I am / I'm
you/we/they	you/we/they are / 're
he/she/it	he/she/it is / 's

Examples:

- I'm a photographer.
- You're married.
- He's from South Africa.
- We're here for a holiday.
- She is single. (She's single.)
- They are explorers. (They're explorers.)

be — negative and questions

Negative: subject + be + NOT. Question: be + subject? Short answers use the full pronoun + be (no contraction at end of YES answer).

Examples:

- I'm not a journalist.
- He isn't from South America.
- They aren't married.

- What's your name? — My name's Mike.
- Where are they from? — They're from Brazil.
- How old is he? — He's thirty-six.
- Are you from Botswana? — Yes, I am. / No, I'm not.
- Is she single? — Yes, she is. / No, she isn't.

Lesson 1b · A family in Kenya

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Topics: family · possessive 's · possessive adjectives · same or different sounds · word roots

Vocabulary — Family

aunt	cousin	father	grandparent
half-brother	mother	mother-in-law	nephew
niece	parent	stepbrother	uncle

Men only: father, grandfather, half-brother, nephew, stepbrother, uncle. Women only: aunt, mother, mother-in-law, niece. Both: cousin, grandparent, parent.

Vocabulary — Word roots

mother → grandmother father → grandfather stepmother → step-grandfather stepfather → step-grandfather stepbrother → step-grandfather half-brother → half-grandfather half-sister → half-grandmother

Learn one root word, then build the family by adding "grand-", "step-", "half-", or "-in-law".

Pronunciation — Same or different sounds

Some pronouns and their possessive forms sound IDENTICAL (homophones). Others have slightly different vowel sounds.

- they're / their — SAME /ðeə(r)/
- he's /hi:z/ vs his /hɪz/ — DIFFERENT
- its / it's — SAME /ɪts/
- are /ɑ:(r)/ vs our /aʊə(r)/ — DIFFERENT
- you're / your — SAME /jʊə(r)/

Possessive 's

Add 's to a name or noun to show possession (ownership / family relation).

Examples:

- Mike's wife is a teacher.
- Louise's mother is Meave.
- Mike and Sally's home is in Canada. (two owners → 's only on the second name)
- Note: 's can also = "is" — "She's a teacher" ('s = is). Use context to tell.

Possessive adjectives

Every subject pronoun has a matching possessive adjective. Use them BEFORE a noun.

I my

you	your
he	his
she	her
it	its (no apostrophe!)
we	our
they	their

Examples:

- She's MY sister.
- What's YOUR name?
- HIS name is Charlie.
- OUR family is from Asia.
- THEIR cousins are both girls.

Lesson 1c · The face of seven billion people

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Topics: numbers · percentages · everyday verbs · word focus: in

Vocabulary — Numbers & percentages

1 billion	1.3 billion (one point three billion)	5.5 billion
7 billion	23% (twenty-three percent)	51%

The decimal point is read as "point". 1.3 = "one point three". "Per cent" (BrE) / "percent" (AmE).

Vocabulary — Everyday verbs

have	live	speak	use
work			

Common pairings: live + **IN** a place, speak + a language, work + **IN** an industry, have + a possession, use + a tool.

Word focus: in

Three common uses of "in" for place/work.

a	in + a country (in the United Kingdom)
b	in + a city or region (in Mexico City)
c	in + a type of work / industry (in the service industry)

Examples:

- 21 million people live **IN** Mexico City.
- There are 65 million people **IN** the United Kingdom.

- 40% of the population work IN the service industry.
- 49% live IN the countryside.

Lesson 1d · First-day skills + world party

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Topics: *alphabet · spelling · meeting people · writing personal description · and / but · world party · video lesson*

Vocabulary — Video — World party (1f)

seven billion	square feet	square mile	foot (feet)
mile	centimetre	kilometre	compare
average	a bit		

USA uses feet/miles; the metric world uses centimetres/kilometres. 1 foot $\approx$ 30 cm; 1 mile $\approx$ 1.6 km. The video shows Chinese New Year in Singapore.

Pronunciation — Spelling — the English alphabet (1d)

Each letter has its own name. Practise spelling personal info: name, surname, country, job.

- A /eɪ/ B /bi:/ C /si:/ D /di:/ E /i:/
- F /ef/ G /dʒi:/ H /etʃ/ I /aɪ/ J /dʒeɪ/
- W /'dʌb(ə)l ju:/ X /eks/ Y /waɪ/ Z /zed/ (BrE) /zi:/ (AmE)
- "Can you spell your first name?" — "It's Pablo. P-A-B-L-O."
- "Can you repeat that?" — "Sure. P-A-B-L-O."

Real life — Meeting people for the first time (1d)

Standard phrases for introducing yourself, introducing another person, and saying goodbye.

Examples:

- Introducing yourself: Hello ... / Hi ... — My name's ... / I'm ... — I'm from ... — Nice to meet you. — Nice to meet you, too.
- Introducing another person: This is ... — He's / She's from ...
- Saying goodbye: See you later. — It was nice meeting you. — Goodbye. / Bye.

Writing skill — "and" and "but" (1e)

Use "and" to add EXTRA / similar information. Use "but" to show a DIFFERENCE or contrast. Note: use a comma before "but" when joining two clauses.

Examples:

- "I'm 21 AND my sister is 21." (same/parallel info → and)
- "I live in Spain, BUT I'm from Argentina." (Spain $\neq$ Argentina → but)
- "I'm from England, BUT I study in the USA."
- "He's from Germany, BUT he works in Russia."
- Tip: when starting from two short sentences, choose AND if they match, BUT if they contrast.